



DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
DEPARTMENT OF MECHANICAL ENGINEERING
UNITED STATES AIR FORCE ACADEMY

8 Dec 2025

Colonel Cory A. Cooper, PhD, USAF
Permanent Professor and Head
Department of Mechanical Engineering
2354 Fairchild Drive, STE 6L-159
United States Air Force Academy, CO 80840

Dear Colleague,

Congratulations! Following review of your initial application for the position of Permanent Professor and Head of the Department of Astronautics at the United States Air Force Academy (USAFA), you have been selected as a semi-finalist. We welcome you to phase two of our selection process and invite you to provide some additional information to aid the committee in our process. Please provide the following items:

- (Optional) A brief (max 2 pages) revised statement of interest in this position and a summary of your relevant qualifications. We recognize that as we learn more about you, you are also gaining a better understanding of the role, expectations, and alignments. If you desire, we offer you an opportunity to provide a revised statement of interest and degree/experience alignment to the position.
- Please review relevant sections of the USAFA Course of Instruction (COI) Handbook for the Astronautical Engineering major (p. 126) and Astronautical Engineering (Astr Engr XXX) courses (p. 308) and provide a brief discussion of how your educational and other qualifications align to the ABET-accredited Astronautical Engineering major. Review and discussion of additional, supported programs and courses may also be included (e.g., Systems Engineering major, Space Warfighting minor, Space Operations). For your reference: <https://www.usafa.edu/academics/> and <https://www.usafa.edu/app/uploads/COI.pdf>
- A full curriculum vitae (CV) not bound by the initial three-page limit imposed in the mini-application phase. Include all scholarly work (i.e., not selected lists).
- Your last 10 OPRs/OPBs. Also include TRs.

Please compile all above items into a single, well-organized, flat pdf file (i.e., not a portfolio), in the format of: *last_first_DFAS_round_2.pdf*, and send it to me via email at cory.cooper@afacademy.af.edu. Your items must be received no later than Sunday, 21 December 2025. I will reply to confirm receipt.

If you need additional information or have any questions, please feel free to contact me via the email above, or by phone at 719-333-6266 (DSN 333). We look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,

CORY A. COOPER, PhD, Colonel, USAF